

I kill and I make alive,
 When I have wounded, I heal,
 And there is no one that can deliver out of my hand.”*

The same thoughts are also expressed elsewhere.† Men were even able to relate that Elijah and Elisha, the envoys of Jahveh, had raised the dead.‡ The expectation that a resurrection would follow death, could easily attach itself to such a belief in Jahveh’s unlimited power. Now after the Babylonish exile, as we have already seen,§ there came over the religious consciousness of the Israelite this great change, that he began to conceive his relation to Jahveh as something individual, as a personal matter, much more than formerly. So the hope—and, since Jahveh did not lack the power, the trust—in the immortality of the individual naturally superseded the belief in *Israel’s* perpetual existence. The one results so regularly and naturally from the other, that the thought of foreign influence does not occur to us at all. The same is true, to a certain degree, of the form which the belief in immortality assumed, the resurrection of the dead. The first who mentions it is Ezekiel: in an ecstasy he beholds a valley full of men’s bones, which afterwards become clothed with flesh and animated by Jahveh’s spirit.|| According to the prophet’s own explanation, this is purely symbolic: the revival of the dead bones is the type of the restoration of the dead Israelitish nation.¶ But it is a symbol which could easily be interpreted literally, because the Israelite’s ideas of the human body and soul and their mutual relation hardly admitted any other notion of man’s existence after death than that of resuscitation, *i.e.*, of the miraculous restoration of the body, into which the spirit returned. It is Jahveh who gives man—or, more generally, man and beast—*spirit*, *i.e.*, life, the breath of life;** he is “the god of the spirits of all flesh.”††

* Deut. xxxii. 39.

† 1 Kings xvii. 22; 2 Kings vi. 35; xiii. 21.

‡ Ezek. xxxvii. 1, seq.

** Gen. ii. 7; Eccles. xii. 7.

† 1 Sam. ii. 6.

§ pp. 29, sq.

¶ Verses 11-14.

†† Num. xvi. 22; xxvii. 16.